

Class #9 - The Matrix Equation $Ax = b$

1. Properties of a linear transformation $T : \mathbf{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbf{R}^n$

(a) $T(0) = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. Why?

Fill in the blank: If $T(u) = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$, then $T(2u) = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ (can use as a test for $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$).

(b) $T(c_1u_1 + c_2u_2) = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

(c) $T(\sum_{i=1}^m c_i u_i) = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$, i.e.,

$T(\text{linear combination of inputs}) = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.

This is called the *Superposition principle*.

2. True or False: There is a nonzero matrix A and a nonzero vector x so that $Ax = 0$.

3. Let $A = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 5 \\ 0 & 3 \\ 3 & 1.5 \end{bmatrix}$ $x = \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{3} \\ e \end{bmatrix}$.

Then $Ax \in \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.

What is the 2nd entry of the product Ax ? $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

Note: The i th entry in the Matrix-vector product = sum of the entrywise product between the $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ of the matrix and $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.

4. Example: $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$.

$Ax = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. This matrix does not change the identity of the vector x .

Note: To have $Ax = x$, what should be the size of A ?

5. Def: The *zero matrix* is a matrix with $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ entry equals to zero.

The $n \times n$ *identity matrix* is the matrix whose diagonals are all $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ and every other entries are $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.

6. Question: Let $A \in \mathbf{R}^{m \times n}$ and $x \in \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. What is a condition on A so that $Ax = b$ has a solution for *all* $b \in \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ (i.e., columns of A span $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$)?

7. Theorem: Let $A \in \mathbf{R}^{m \times n}$ and $b \in \mathbf{R}^m$. The following are equivalent (TFAE):

- (a) $Ax = b$ is consistent for all b .
- (b) Every $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ of A has a pivot position.
- (c) Every vector in $\mathbf{R}^m$ is a $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ of the $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ of A .
- (d) Columns of A span $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.

8. Question: Given nonzero vectors $u_1, u_2, \dots, u_p$ in $\mathbf{R}^m$, how do we check if $u_i \notin \text{Span}\{u_j : j = 1, \dots, i-1\}$ for each $i = 2, \dots, p$?

Idea:

Look at the matrix

$$\begin{bmatrix} u_1 & u_2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Case 1: If $u_2 \in \text{Span}\{u_1\}$, then how many pivot positions? $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

Case 2: If $u_2 \notin \text{Span}\{u_1\}$, then how many pivot positions? $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$

If Case 1 occurs, then $u_2 \in \text{Span}\{u_1\}$.

If Case 2 occurs, then

check the matrix

$$\begin{bmatrix} u_1 & u_2 & u_3 \end{bmatrix}.$$

If this matrix has $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ pivot positions, then $u_3 \notin \text{Span}\{u_1, u_2\}$.

Fill in the blank: $u_i \notin \text{Span}\{u_1, \dots, u_{i-1}\}$ when the matrix _____ has pivot positions in every _____.

9. Suppose $A \in \mathbf{R}^{m \times n}$. What is the maximum number of pivot positions that A can have?

So, span of the columns of A is a _____ of _____, and the columns of A can never span $\mathbf{R}^m$ if m _____ n .